

Murata Mfg. (6981.T): Conf call takeaways: Reconfirming short & long-term MLCC strength and company's strong position, Buy (on CL)

We held a conference call on September 24. Key points were as follows. **(1) MLCC orders continue to be strong:** The company envisions a trend where high levels were maintained in July following a surge in orders in June (+25-30% mom), a decrease in August due to the Obon holidays, and a seasonal increase in September. In that case, the July-September BB ratio is likely to remain very strong, on par with or slightly below the April-June level (1.47x), and there is a possibility that this very strong situation will continue (the order backlog also continues to increase). Looking at the breakdown, strength in AI/DC applications stands out, smartphone applications are increasing due to seasonality, and automotive applications are on a flat trend. **(2) MLCC capacity utilization:** Against initial guidance of just under 95% in April-June -> around 95% in July-September -> over 95% in 2H, the company is focused on how much further it can raise this (whether it can increase output). Factories operated even through the Obon holidays and Silver Week. Changes in specifications for MLCCs for AI/DCs have settled down, leading to a tendency where efficient production line management (= production expansion) is easier to promote. **(3) MLCC capacity expansion:** Plans for a little over +10% in FY3/27 and +20-25% in FY3/28 are on track. Furthermore, anticipating demand expansion from FY3/29 onward, the company is considering capacity expansion plans including buildings. The company wishes to make a decision during FY3/27 and commented on the possibility that AI/DC applications could account for 20-25% of MLCC sales in FY3/27 and just under 40% in FY3/28. **(4) MLCC prices:** The three conditions for price hikes remain unchanged: when the impact of price hikes by other companies emerges (when customers who do not use Murata as their main supplier shift their orders to Murata), when its own production costs rise, and to control demand for distributors. The stance is to basically not raise prices and to respond locally. Regarding price revision negotiations for automotive customers from January, the company's image is to avoid price cuts rather than raising prices, and the company envisions a large profit increase effect due to a reduction in the impact of yoy price declines in FY3/28. **(5) RF/BBU/AI power supplies:** In design-ins for FY3/28 RF models, the company aims to expand market share in the transmission section (PA) in addition to the reception section. BBU/AI power supplies are expanding at the planned pace. Our impression is that the certainty of earnings improvement in the devices/modules segment in FY3/28 is increasing.

In conclusion, we maintain our positive view on the stock as a core name in the Japanese electronic components/semiconductor sector. We expect a second upward revision for this fiscal year at the interim earnings announcement. Our

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impression is that discussions in the stock market are shifting away from extreme expectations for MLCC price hikes to evaluating the company's sustainable earnings growth potential and competitiveness backed by its product development and production technology capabilities. On this point, we are once again realizing possibilities such as capacity utilization increases and production output expansion beyond equipment capacity, competitiveness and mix improvement for AI/DCs, and growth sustainability from FY3/29 onward. We believe the share price will continue to rise over time, and we maintain our Buy rating (on CL).

Price Target Risks and Methodology – Murata Mfg.

Valuation methodology: We are Buy rated on Murata Mfg. with a 12-month price target of ¥12,900. Our target price is based on a FY3/29E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying an 80% premium to our sector multiple of 10X (implies FY3/29E P/E of 30X).

Key risks: Decline in smartphone production volume, deterioration in MLCC supply/demand, and yen appreciation.

6981.T	12m Price Target: ¥12,900	Price: ¥7,763	Upside: 66.2%
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Buy CL		GS Forecast				
Market cap: ¥15.7tr / \$100.0bn Enterprise value: ¥14.9tr / \$94.9bn 3m ADTV: ¥223.4bn / \$1.4bn Japan Japan Electronic Components/Semiconductors M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No			3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
		Revenue (¥ bn)	1,830.9	2,195.8	2,620.0	3,080.0
		Op. profit (¥ bn)	281.8	485.0	700.0	895.0
		Op. profit CoE (¥ bn)	270.0	430.0	–	–
		EPS (¥)	128.5	220.0	328.1	436.3
		P/E (X)	21.5	35.3	23.7	17.8
		P/B (X)	2.0	5.0	4.3	3.6
		Dividend yield (%)	2.4	0.9	1.0	1.0
		N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	(1.4)	(1.1)	(1.1)	(1.2)
		CROCI (%)	13.7	17.8	22.6	26.9
			6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
EPS (¥)		46.6	57.9	60.4	55.1	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 18 Sep 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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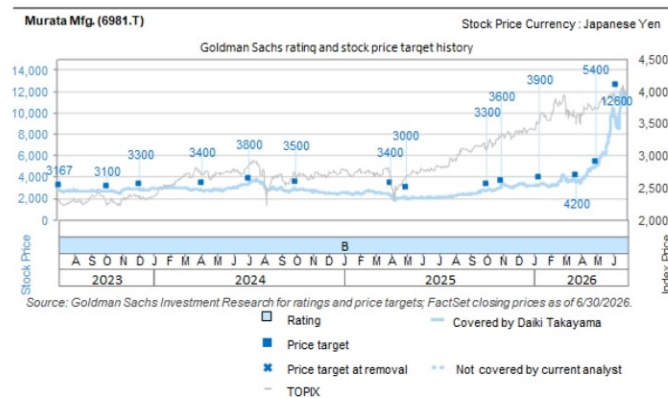
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Murata Mfg. (6981.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
31-Jul-26	12,900	7,416
08-Jun-26	12,600	8,711
30-Apr-26	5,400	5,156
23-Mar-26	4,200	3,508
12-Jan-26	3,900	3,194
31-Oct-25	3,600	3,392
02-Oct-25	3,300	2,770
30-Apr-25	3,000	2,214
31-Mar-25	3,400	2,306
01-Oct-24	3,500	2,893
02-Jul-24	3,800	3,364
03-Apr-24	3,400	2,768
06-Dec-23	3,300	2,892
04-Oct-23	3,100	2,657

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